

BenQ T91W

Good but pricey

The T91W is the latest LCD offering from the BenQ stables. It can be tilted up to 20° up and 5° down vertically, but it can't be tilted horizontally. The three buttons on the monitor take care of all the functions, but they are placed behind the monitor—inconvenient. Furthermore, the buttons seem tacky, and are unresponsive at times.

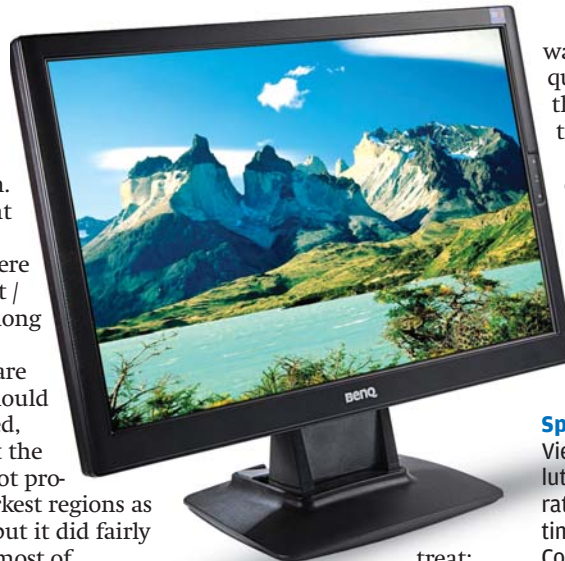
This 19-incher is sleek, and weighs just 4.8 kg. It has a widescreen aspect ratio of 16:10, and supports a native resolution of 1440 x 900—something movie buffs will love. With a fast response time of just 5 ms (milliseconds) for grey-to-grey, this one will not disappoint gamers either; it is just as good for fast-paced gaming as your CRT.

The T91W has an excellent contrast ratio of 700:1. The 300 cd/m² brightness

spec is more than enough. The backlight is placed evenly, so there are no bright / dark spots along the border.

Colours are vibrant. It should be mentioned, though, that the LCD could not produce the darkest regions as pure black, but it did fairly better than most of the LCDs we've tested. It has wide viewing angles of 160° for text and 150° for movies. Movies on this monitor are a

RATINGS	
Performance	★★★★★
Features	★★★★★
Build Quality	★★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★



treat; games look equally good. The black borders become inconspicuous while viewing, adding to the immersive experience.

VESA wall mounting is supported. Power consumption is 45 W at full load and 2 W in standby mode, meaning significant savings on your electricity bill. BenQ has put in a pair of speakers, though you might never

want to use them—the quality of these is nothing that really deserves a mention.

The sore point: a DVI connector is lacking. This will really be missed by videophiles who demand the purest of video signals. In the final analysis, we think Rs 13,400 for the BenQ T91W is a little too much.

Specifications

Viewable size 19"; Native resolution: 1440 x 900; Aspect ratio: wide (16:10); Response time: 5 ms (grey-to-grey); Contrast Ratio: 700:1; brightness: 300 cd/m²; Interface: D-Sub; power consumption: 45 W (max), 2 W (standby); Dimensions: 381.2 x 449.2 x 185.2 mm (H x W x D); Weight: 4.8 kg; Stereo speakers inbuilt

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Price: **Rs 13,400**

HAVA Wireless HD

The leap to video streaming

Wi-Fi streaming devices are a dime a dozen, but HAVA has several aces up its sleeve to differentiate from me-too products. To begin with, it's a video streaming device with a TV-Tuner inbuilt. Yes—TV programmes can be streamed within your home or on the Internet.

Setting up the HAVA unit requires a basic understanding of networking. Configuring the appliance does take considerable time, but it wasn't overly difficult. DHCP (Dynamic Host Configuration Protocol) is well-implemented, and the

settings are comprehensive.

Local wireless clients connect automatically once DHCP is activated in the embedded WebServer. If you so want, the device can be hooked up via a regular Ethernet connection—simple and effective. The setup Wizard is designed with two options, Basic and Advanced—thoughtful. Basic mode doesn't concern itself with Security or advanced networking protocols; one can use Advanced mode to configure these.

The unit comes bundled with and IR-Blaster (the IR emitter module), which can be used to control streaming devices such as a DVD player, satellite receiver, etc. attached to the HAVA unit. The remote control is software-based; it drives the IR Blaster. The software on the client side—



your PC or laptop connected to the HAVA over Wi-Fi or Ethernet—allows simple control over the TV-Tuner. It also allows recording of live streams onto the client PC.

On the performance front, the HAVA Wireless HD can stream 720 x 480 MPEG2 video at a constant 5 to 6 Mbps. We didn't encounter jerky video or lag in the audio stream. The device can directly stream to the Internet at 320 x 240 in the MPEG4 format, and it requires 300 Kbps+ bandwidth. Using the HAVA Mobile Player (available at the Web site), the live video stream can be

received on a cell phone; the Mobile Player only supports Pocket PC 5 / 6.

Rs 16,500 is steep for a device like this one, but it is unique, and is appealing.

Specifications

Video source (in/out): Composite, S-Video, Antenna, and Component Video; networking: Ethernet, Wi-Fi (802.11g); software: HAVA Setup Wizard, HAVA PC Player

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Price: **Rs 16,500**

RATINGS	
Performance	★★★★★
Features	★★★★★
Ease of Installation	★★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★